

Correlation research on user age and avatar characteristics

1.1. This research will be mixed-method study with a correlation approach. All the collective knowledge will be based and referenced from past research on the topic being discussed. Examples of such for this project are shown in the supporting documents up above. Research sources that will be collected from reliable sources such as Google Scholar, Refseek and ResearchGate (Evidence 56).

Since this research project was about finding a correlation between user age and their personally chosen avatar characteristics for an audience of service providers of gaming platforms, there was several questions to cover to research and answer. For instance, the first question was what can be taken away by personalized avatars that reflect back on users? If research can find out what the choices that reflect back on the profile of a user, there is great potential for monetizing off predictions on future user behavior. But this begs the question on what influences and motivates the decisions of a user on their personalizing their avatars in a certain way. Past research has found that users are motivated to interact, feel a sense of achievement, escapism, power, manipulation. Social interaction with others users on a platform correlate quite a bit with rates of avatar customization. This suggests that users are motivated to personalize their avatars based on how they self-perceive themselves might become, would like to become and what they are afraid of becoming. Which leads to this research to conclude to users use their own perception of themselves, others and the world to influence their choices on their personal avatar.

Another aspect that influences a user's choices is the platform context. Platform context refers to the game world and rules that their personal avatar must inhabit in. A good example of influence in avatar customization is a platform with a wild western platform context with cowboys: a user is given a choice between a lawman and criminal. The user will personalize their avatar based on the context of the wild west. But these choices are not going the same if the platform context was different too such as medieval times with knights and dragons. The user's changing of choices in personalize avatar through platform contexts show that user choose aspects of avatar characteristics that reflect an aspect of themselves (Evidence 49). This research also needed past research on prediction models and their use in the gaming industry by analytics. Contextualizing targeted advertising and user profiling is useful to diagnose what best helps a service provider to succeed on a gaming platform. Past research has found target advertising and user profiling benefit from a good user experience to incentives high levels of engagement from users (Evidence 49).

The final questions is trying to find a method properly gauge a user in spite of other influences such as platform context? This is why this research use a theory called personal psychology theory. This theory stipulates that people's perspectives, and therefore their actions, stem from a collection of opposing aspects of their observations. People choose things based on their past experiences and bi-polars opposites. A person can't know what "hot" without knowing what "cold" is. People have constructs on how they perceive the world, themselves and others. These constructs are maintained by others. In the context of personalized avatars: knowing a person's repertory grid/ construct on avatars will help service

providers to know how that person's will choose in the future despite a changing platform context. For example: If Robert perceives himself as a lover, a manager, a father and a dancer, then he would change his avatar accordingly per platform. LinkedIn is a work-based context platform, so he is likely to make his own avatar to emphasize himself as a manager. Twitter and Facebook are social-based context platforms, so Robert would be inclined to create his avatar to emphasize his self-perception as a lover and a father. Tik-Tok's platform context would push him towards making a dancer avatar profile of himself. A person's choices on avatar will change per platform context, but their repertory grid will not change. A repertory grid is a technique used to that tries to capture the main constructs used by the individual.

One of the facets of personal construct psychology is that everyone learns in a similar experience along the same learning curve when centered on a single topic. This research can use only the topic of customizing avatars a large variety of people, both experienced and inexperienced, to create a general repertory grid on how both groups view and differentiate between avatars. These differentiating avatar characteristics could be, for instance, clothes, face, hairstyle and attitude. Thus, this justifies the need for a set of interviews to be conducted on random participants of different age groups to gauge a general, or superset repertory grid. The resulting superset repertory grid is found in the (Evidence 49). The interviews were made by a list of pre-existing avatars that participants had to choose to compare what they perceive in avatars. This list can be found at the appendix (Evidence 16) and (Evidence 42).

Two surveys are needed to find the correlation between user age and avatar characteristics. One survey to collect user age alongside a screenshot of the user's personalized avatars from the Ready Player Me customization generator. A second survey is needed to rate those created avatars from the first survey through the superset repertory grid that was created in the interviews. One survey cannot achieve the same result as the second survey needs a pre-existing list of avatars to rate from. Consistency is ensure in the first survey when a specific platform context is given for user's to create from. The second survey requires multiple ratings per avatar (2-3) to find an average trend in ratings per avatar characteristic. These multiple ratings help clean and find noise in the data noise with regards to outliers rating that go against with the more general ratings. For example: if an avatar has been rated by the majority of raters as heroic than villain, then the outlier rating would be minority that rates as it's opposite, the villain. When testing for correlation, noise is not taken into account when finding a correlation.

Linear regression is being used as a basis for testing for a correlation between user age and avatar characteristics. Linear regression is simple and versatile as well as an element that is used in other more complex models. The results found in a linear model will be a good indicator on the potential results on other types of modeling (Evidence 49).

1.2. The research will always come back to how it is not only relevant to the improvement of an gaming platform but also how the linear model can be constructed from the data results.

Gaming platforms have found in the research from the ratings of avatars that people prefer a large variety of choices to choose for themselves in order to personalize avatars. Especially so with users in their 20s. This is in accordance with past research where it was found that people engage more with the

platform if they identify or make their own avatar on the gaming platform. The success of targeted advertising is very much in conjunction to how engaged a user is to a platform. The more engaged the user, the better the chances of success in targeted advertising (Evidence 16).

Finding a linear correlation relationship (model) between user age and avatar characteristics was difficult to manage in initial tests as they couldn't find any correlation (Evidence 16). This was echoed in the correlation matrix between user age and avatar characteristics (Evidence 11). The highest correlation with user age was the avatar characteristics of "young vs. middle-aged" as the value of 0.209445. Since perfectly or highly correlated relationship is found when close to 1, this avatar characteristics and the rest of the avatar characteristics indicate that there very much a weak correlated relation to user age.

Since it was harder to prove a lack of correlation in machine learning, there needed to further testing to be made to properly ensure that there was no correlation between user age and avatar characteristics. These include new methods like principal component analysis (PCA) and determining the influence of noise (Evidence 49). PCA is needed since it was found in the correlation matrix of a dependency (correlated) relation between the x-variables (avatar characteristics). In linear regression, it is assumed that all x-variables are independent. These dependent x-variables (avatar characteristics) could be muddling the correlation results. The PCA correlation matrix is shown in the appendix (Evidence 16) and is used to rest of testing.

Noise refers the inaccurate data the changes the result. Linear regression doesn't see noise, therefore testing through the removal outliers of avatar ratings will be used as a measure to compare with initial tests to see the influence of noise. In the case of this current research, noise is referring to outlier avatar ratings that is wholly different from the other ratings on the same avatar. The random variance refers to repeated tests of randomly selected set of avatars to test correlation. This is meant to cut out the possibility of outlier coefficient of determination that could be caused by the change sample size. The results are found in the report's finding (Evidence 16).

The end results has found little influence from noise. But it was found that there was a reduced average correlation value (coefficient of determination) due to a increasing volume of avatars put into the dataset. Further testing has confirmed that the higher the sample of size of avatars, the lower the correlation is found between user age and avatar characteristics (Evidence 49).

This whole research has been a proof of concept to prove a hypothesis of a strong correlation relationship between user age and avatar characteristics. The findings has not confirmed this hypothesis. The results show that to finding out the emotion drivers of users in designing avatars has less to do in relation to how old they are but more to do with their emotions, behaviors and personalities. This research confirms this conclusion in a quantitative way. However, the lack of noise found in the research does uplift the repertory grid method as a good technique to quantitatively gauge a user's own emotion drivers with respective to topic of avatars (Evidence 49).

1.3. The problems of this project will be solved by the data collection of a large sample group that will help answer whether there is a correlation or not between user age and avatar characteristics.

One problem was incentivizing and verifying a large sample to rate more one avatar on a survey. This was solved with the Qualtrics survey allowing participants to do the survey multiple times. Multiple takes on the survey was encouraged since every take on the survey was on a single randomized avatar out of 200+. Applying an randomizer allows for the participants to re-take the survey as many times as they wish based on how well they enjoyed it. The verification of the survey is made by a line of choice on rating an avatar, this serves as an attention check that is clarified in the beginning of the survey. Participants would pass the attention check if they answer the same in both repeated lines of rating characteristic. This also serves as more of an intuitive approach for participants that have not read the instructions to simply give the same answer for both lines. This verification not allows proper ratings for participants but also not lose the potential participants (Evidence 7) (Evidence 8).

What ensures all avatars are rated over time is a weekly check on the rating results from participants. Any avatar that has been rating two or more times are taken out of the Qualtrics survey flow. Each specific avatar and their ratings are organized into their own blocks and can be easily taken out of the randomizer to allow for the rest of the avatars to be rated (Evidence 43) (Evidence 32).

One problem after the data collection was finding correlation between user age and avatar characteristics. The solution was constant testing, cleaning the data and finding the correlation matrix (Evidence 11) (Evidence 33) (Report) (Evidence 49) (Evidence 51) (Evidence 52).

1.4. The specialized knowledge and critical insights needed to complete this project will be an exhaustive list of in-depth research which includes information about service providers, user profiles, avatars, the tools of Ready Player Me to best characterize the parameters needed to help find a correlation between user age and avatar characteristics (Evidence 16).

Once this is characterized, the parameters will be used to model a correlation between all relevant avatar characteristics and user age based on participant responses.

The practical application of this project that is needed is participants to rate avatar characteristics, create their own avatars on the Ready Player Me website and answer the survey questions to inform about their real-life user profile category (user age). The analysis of these results will determine whether a correlation exists between avatar characteristics and user profiles. The results of the surveys is in the CSV file (Evidence 43).

Any other unknown specialized knowledge and insights will be reported and written down in the academic research, this includes the learning of finding correlations and an in-depth overview of past research that is relevant to this topic to avatars and correlation research.

The specialized knowledge is about python, the exploration of different tests, and the work (Evidence 20) (Evidence 21) (Evidence 22) (Evidence 23) (Evidence 24).

2.1. This project will maintain complete professional quality from language, project structure down to the research approach/ methodology. Everything will be presented clearly, concisely and up to what is

expected of a CB professional. The audience, which is service providers of gaming platforms, will be given advice and attention with regards to the research question (Evidence 49).

For example, the relevance of this project to service providers of gaming platforms by finding a correlation between user age and avatar characteristics is finding out what makes user ticks in regards to personalizing avatars. The potential of such a found correlation is that service providers can use this relationship to predict future user behaviors on the platform. The knowledge of knowing what to expect allows service providers to plan ahead on making improvements on a user's experience on the platform. For instance, if all users are predicted to their personalized avatars as more "heroic" than "villainous", service providers can take advantage by presenting and selling more avatar characteristics to users that allow them to look more "heroic". Avatars are the key to engaging new users on a platform. Therefore, finding out how and why a user personalizing their avatar in a certain is important to predict future user behavior and needs as well as finding out what motivates current users on the platform. And this starts with how users tend to differentiate between avatars.

Other stakeholders that could be relevant to this project is researchers in user profiling, avatars and repertory grids. This current research shows in its findings how users, in general, differentiate between avatars in opposing characteristics. The findings also indicate through the low rate of noise found in ratings from the superset repertory grid that this is a good basis to profile user perspective on specific topics. This is relevant to user profiling for future research to a test on a much larger group of participants than this current research to further gauge how people, in general, seeing and experiencing avatars. Repertory grids is a very versatile tool, the application of it in this research is can be applied to other areas of study such as marketing, survey taking and gauging drivers of identity.

This current research is professional quality as it maintains what past research has found and done. The methodology is has been made, found and backed up by past research. The methodology alongside the findings and results were checked by via consulting experts and relevant sources (Evidence 31) (Evidence 56). The document structure has been checked with APA rules, school criteria, and past APA styled research papers. The relevance and advice to service providers of gaming platforms have been made most apparently in the discussion. All of the advice to stakeholders have been backed up by this current research and past research for reference. For instance, one piece of advice for service providers was to maintain a good user experience for users. Long-standing communities and user loyalty starts with the avatars that they make on the platform but it is the user experience on the platform that helps make users stay on the platform. The more that user feels engaged, comfortable and welcomed on a platform, the more that they eventually be susceptible to targeted ads. So long as the targeted ads are relevant to the gaming experience.

2.2. This project completion, research, data collection and conclusion will be managed solely by me. Therefore all project deadlines will be completed to the desired quality of answering the research question to professional quality.

The deadlines, research, data collection, and conclusions were managed and completed by myself (Evidence 50) (Evidence 51) (Evidence 54).

The desired output or research aim of finding a correlation was prioritized over meeting the first final deadline at July for the Capstone. To achieve this, more time and effort was required to meet the methodology of making, organizing and conducting interviews of more than 10 participants. Then conducting two surveys to collect user age, personalize avatars and their ratings per avatar characteristics. A minimum of 100 personalized avatars alongside the user age and the 2-3 ratings per avatar on all avatar characteristics based on the superset repertory grid from the interviews. Meaning that each avatar needed to be rating 2-3 times around 20 avatar characteristics per avatar. Hence, a minimum of 4,000 or 6,000 ratings total. Therefore the desired output was found in testing for correlation between the resulting avatar ratings and user age (Evidence 49).

These deadline were met with help of pre-existing social networks on platforms such as Reddit, Discord and LinkedIn over the summer. The channels of data collection was ensured with programs like Google Sheets and Qualtrics. The resulting output in the end was more than 200 personalized avatars listed and ratings totaling a minimum range between 8,000 and 12,000 ratings. More than a handful of avatars acquired more than 2-3 ratings.

The desired quality was ensure through testing and verification of the data (avatar ratings) found by the finding the influence of noise and PCA. It was determined, due to the low rate of noise found in the ratings, that there is less correlation value between user age and avatar characteristics if there is an increase in volume of avatars. Hence the verification helps achieve the desired quality and research aim of answer whether or not there is a correlation between user age and avatar characteristics. Which is there is no positive relation.

2.3. This project will have no strict supervision. There will be no company to help to complete this research. All supervision will be done by the school coordinators and I will solely be responsible to myself to get academic research finished before the deadline.

The deadlines, research, data collection, and conclusions were made and managed by myself. The evidence is in the dates and data of versions from my report, surveys, notes and conclusion (Evidence 18) (Evidence 19) (Evidence 3) (Evidence 4) (Evidence 5) (Evidence 9) (Evidence 49).

I made sure to minimize any lacking quality and oversight in my project by consulting the relevant experts who know more than me. The research quality was also checked and researched for any inconsistency from past research papers that studied a similar topic to this current research(Evidence 49). I ensured this with consistent contact and initiating conversations with said supervisor and experts (Evidence 28) (Evidence 29) (Evidence 31).

The research aim of this current research was to find a correlation relationship between user age and avatar characteristics. I had initially find in initial tests and the correlation matrix. The end result had shown no correlation between the two. However, I learned that, in machine learning, it is easier to prove that there is a correlation than a lack of correlation. Thus, I needed to take the extra steps to definitively prove that there is no correlation. This was achieved with by PCA and testing the influence of noise in the dataset. The model that I was using, which was linear regression, does not see noise in the dataset and therefore any noise from the dataset would muddle the end correlation result. But after going these extra steps, I had proved on my own initiative that there was no correlation. I had also

found additional observations in trends between the age groups in each avatar characters. For example, the majority of users that made avatars preferred to present themselves as free, idealistic, confident, attractive and groomed (Evidence 49).

3.1. All communication will be conducted between me and the school. Every need and issue required by the school and/or the academic research will not just be communicated but addressed with the utmost readiness.

The needs of my stakeholder, the school, were found to be understanding and improving on the concept of my project. I addressed with communication, presentations and evidence to help my stakeholders understand the project. The better I could get them to understand my project, the better I could get others to understand my research (Evidence 34).

This problem of understanding was also found upon reviewing the research made on the document. There was more than a few instances where anyone unfamiliar with my current research topic would be lost when trying to understand what I've done. Most of these explanations has to be addressed in the introduction, methodology and findings. More explanations and defining topics helped make the current research paper to better understood than before to anyone new reading the document. The relevant needs and desires to service providers were introduced and addressed in the discussion of the research report (Evidence 49). An added benefit to addressing these types of problems is what helped address and clarify what this current research was trying to aim for. As pointed out in the learned lesson sections, this current research was initially aiming to make a prediction model and assumed that prediction models were interchangeable with correlations. Based on feedback, the focus of this research changed from making a prediction model to finding a correlation between user age and avatar characteristics which then would have the potential for prediction modeling.

3.2. Collaboration and communication will be done between participants that receive the surveys and get feedback from school supervisors on said progress. Any and all collaboration will have all participants be treated with respect and honesty.

All relevant stakeholders in the project, which in the context of this project, is service providers on gaming platforms are always mentioned throughout my report with consistent advise on what to think and do about in every research topic (Evidence 49).

Communication is ensured in the surveys with a feedback question bar at the end of the survey (Evidence 44) (Evidence 45) (Evidence 46) (Evidence 47) (Evidence 48). The interviews were done with respect and no pressure placed on any of the interviewees, it was simply trying to gauge their opinion (Evidence 31). Communication is remotely reinforced by the platforms that these surveys were shared on Reddit, WhatsApp, SurveySwap and LinkedIn (Evidence 25) (Evidence 26) (Evidence 27) (Evidence 6) (Evidence 7) (Evidence 8) (Evidence 17) (Evidence 19).

3.3. The communication of ideas will be shared clearly and concisely through the Capstone project with the school. Any confusion or misunderstandings with the projects between me and the supervisors will be cleared with consistent communication.

Communication on the teacher and the group. They had a hard time understanding my project, I realized that visual aids and proper examples allowed for better explanations for the concepts that I was researching in my project (Evidence 34).

Complex ideas and problems were discussed with the experts that I've contacted in particular in regards with the progress track on my correlation research (Evidence 31).

4.1. Any setbacks and mistakes made in the research collection and findings will be recorded immediately for future reflection based on the answers that were made in the Capstone.

I made the mistake for assuming that I could finish the project before July of 2022 and I wanted to do multiple modes of research and methodology (interviews and two surveys) with the aim of large sample to complete the project with. I have been told that what I was doing was somewhat unrealistic before the deadline but I was stubborn. However, I realize now that I need the summer to help finish my project, which doesn't help my initiative to complete my deadlines. But I persevered and committed to finishing what I had started with this Capstone research. What I learned from this project is that I need keep better awareness on any and all projects that I undertake to schedule and better meet deadlines in the future (Evidence 50) (Evidence 51) (Evidence 54).

One weakness in this study was my insistence on the targeted advertising aspect at the beginning of the project. But I later learned that engaging users is more important to gaming service provider in contrast to a social media service provider. But I feel that this is a important distinction to make despite the many similarities that user profiling for both avenues need to succeed. User profiling of any kind needs specific goal or problem to solve in mind when collecting and condensing large amounts of user data. Targeted advertising and it's effectiveness varies on a large scale based on the context of the platform that it is set in. This is one of the good pointers that I've learned from this project. Evidence in show in my proposal in the appendix (Evidence 16).

Another initial assumption that I feel limits my study was the assumption that this study would extend a user profile's parameters from a gamer experience in relation to their social media user profile. The combination of both profiles would, in theory, create a better basis to profile and identify any needs or problems that a user has to that service providers would be keen to solve for further engagement and monetization (Evidence 10).

I made another mistake in the beginning by assuming that everyone knew and understand complex ideas the same way that I've had. But my project reached into areas my contemporaries in my studies have not, for example: machine learning. This has help me learned that communication and understanding is just if not more important the actual research of my project. If other people cannot understand my research project, how can they understand my results. I absolved this problems by answering questions and giving visual presentations on my project (Evidence 34).

4.2. Feedback on any aspect of the research will be welcome. Feedback creates an opportunity for valuable insight and unconsidered perspectives towards answering the research question. I don't believe this research, it's approach and the accumulated knowledge is without fault, feedback gives me a chance to possibly minimize potential problems and limitations on this research. This feedback can

come from anywhere but will typically come in the form of discussions and communication with the school throughout the duration of the project.

I contacted and received feedback on my research project from both my supervisor and experts on the subject. The feedback from the supervisor was crucial in understanding what people not familiar with my research topic would ask. The feedback from experts made sure that my methodology, aims and research was on track towards finding a correlation as well as suggest other areas that I've not considered before (Evidence 31) (Evidence 35).

4.3. The learning skills will be the reapplication of quantitative research methods in the project, the learning of the creation of the linear regression modeling and other applications of machine learning, multivariable statistics that are available in packages such as Python. I will also learn aspects such as the value of avatars to users in today's media landscape, especially from an user and advertiser's perspective. Learning whether there is a connection between user profiles and avatar characteristics could open so many avenues and possibilities to research further on and monetize for the target audience (Evidence 16).

I definitely learned that user profiling is more broad and multi-faceted than I had ever considered. The typical image that comes to mind in regards to user-profiling is the invasion of privacy to user data from their search history, tweets, messages, devices and network of family and friends etc. But user profiling is simply a tool, a technique that data analysts and marketers use to compress large amounts of raw data to solve a user need or problem to increase engagement to said problem. Well, that seems to be case with video-game user profiling. User profiling in social media is similar but different in context and aims from their service providers (Evidence 49).

I also learned that python is more simple than I thought. There were plenty of sources and tutorials that was similar problem that I was trying to solve. I am aware that I merely scratching the surface in this research project. But I do know is testing for a correlation is more of a trial and error issue, I assume other pythons problems is similar to my own (Evidence 31) (Evidence 49).

One mistake was based on the assumption that prediction modeling and correlation research are interchangeable. At the beginning of this project, I was misunderstanding the fundamentals of the machine learning when it comes to modeling and correlation. While they are related, they are not interchangeable. Modeling is about finding a causation between the x variables to y. Correlation is not always in the equation of the modeling as while causation can have correlation, correlation cannot find causation in model. Therefore, my initial approach to find correlation through regression models was flawed. Meaning that it was not necessary to have said modeling and simply find the correlation matrix between x factors with y. I therefore learned more about the fundamentals of linear regression assumptions, PCA, and determining the influence of noise. I changed my approach in this current research accordingly to provide concrete conclusions from my data (Evidence 10) (Evidence 49).

The results of these new approach has shown me that there is more steps in machine learning than anticipated. Using methods such as PCA and determining the influence of noise has helped definitively prove a weak correlation linear relation between user age and avatar characteristics that is aligned with the assumptions of linear regression models. I've learned from these results the lack of correlation was

not due to noise of the dataset but the increasing volume of avatars added in the to the testing section. Hence, the data-size affects the correlated relationship between user age and avatar characteristics. This pushes the conclusions that a person's age is not very dominant in determining their design choices on their personal avatars. Other variables such as personality, habits and behaviors could have more of a dominant factor in influencing design choices. What I also learned in the end of the project is that the use of the repertory grid had yielded a very low rate of noise in avatar ratings. This shows promise for future researchers on trying looking for emotional drivers of a user on specific topic such as avatars (Evidence 49).

5.1. Safety and transparency will be first and foremost in this research. This research will only ask for volunteers to take part in answering survey questions. What the research will be about will be made clear before they start answering the questions and they will always be free to leave if they are uncomfortable with the questions that are being asked. Obviously, participants always have the option to remain anonymous when answering these questions. (Evidence 31) (Evidence 36) (Evidence 55)

Since the information about users' needs to be freely given and easy to quantify from a lot amount of participants, one ethical problem that arises in this project was which user profile quality to focus that could also relevant in finding a relation between user profiles and avatar characteristics. The solution of this problem was to research user age. User age is easy to quantify, easy to recall, unlikely to tampered by bias as participants will be anonymous, and has a relation to repertory grids and avatar designs. This is because the avatar customization is more mainstream to current younger generations than previous generations, therefore the experience of designing avatars is likely to be different, in general, between the generations. This level of experience and exposure drives perception of avatars itself, and that perception drives and determines the actions taken to design their personal avatars.

The realization of this research to better predict user behaviors and needs on a gaming platform does pose a ethical issue on user profiling. Service providers could use this profiling to better empower themselves to engage and trap users onto their platforms to purchase more and distract them from solving their own real-life problems. However, it should be noted that profiling and engagement plans for users is a tool to be used for many purposes. Service providers could use this new profiling tool on avatars to better monetize and attract higher engagement levels from an increasing platform similar to how social media uses outrage and paranoia to drive up clicks and noise to keep it's users engaged. But said new profiling tool could be used to improve and enhance the user experience to better themselves, sense of self and self-esteem in the long term. This has been confirmed in past research (Evidence 49). Said positive outreach is possible and more preferable in the long term for both service providers and users as they both will eventually get what they wish for: service providers is the engagement levels and users, the entertainment and community of willing -users. It is far better to aim for this such a platform scenario than the previous one for branding purposes for attracting new in a welcoming and happy community. But it's all on the service providers to decide how they wish this new tool of profiling when it is realized.

Another ethical issue from this research if realized is a potential privacy issue. A user's personal avatar will be used to profile by service providers on how that user wishes to present themselves. Past research has indicate that users tend to be motivated by a variety of types such as socializing, manipulating and achievement. Service providers that understand how each or how most users are motivated on their makes users more susceptible to plans of targeted ads that fulfill their motivations on said platforms.

This issue does indirectly take information from users without consent via avatars but it is not taking detailed personal information. The best case scenario for users from this type of profiling is that they get better personalized and relevant ads that have the potential to improve their user experience on the platform if they wished it so. A bad scenario is where users are targeted via their insecurities and self-perceived flaws to stay on the platform and be miserable while purchasing items they neither want or need. A solution is needed where users are informed by service providers that they will be profiling and targeted in that certain way. Government agencies should also take steps to oversee said service providers to ensure that there is no foul play or abuse of said users is done in the name of maximizing profits.

5.2. The difference in cultural background of participants will be taken into account for analysis of the research. However, the knowledge about their cultural background needs to be answered voluntarily. No participants are required to answer what cultural or ethnic background they ascribe to (Evidence 1) (Evidence 2).

It is acknowledged as a limitation for conducting a data collection from the interviews and surveys only in English, thus restricting any person who does not speak English from participating.

The surveys were not conducted in person. However, there was a variety of peoples with difference cultural backgrounds that participated (Evidence 12) (Evidence 13) (Evidence 14) (Evidence 15). Everyone was welcomed on those surveys to avoid any issue of rebuffing any specific group of people (Evidence 6) (Evidence 7) (Evidence 8). The interviews were conducted not in person. However, if it was conducted in person with much large pool of participants, the chances of finding different verbalizations from people from different cultures is much higher. Culture, just like language, age and exposure to avatars, affects the perception and how people verbalize the differences between avatars. The result would lead to a larger repertory grid set that can be used by more people with different cultures.

5.3. Answers and volunteers will be collected online and therefore, more than likely that all volunteers/ participants will be from a variety of different cultural backgrounds. Anything unethical, offensive to other specific cultures will be removed and accounted for when raised in collaboration with participants. (Evidence 12) (Evidence 13) (Evidence 14) (Evidence 15)

This project has been collected from participants from all over the world, mostly from reddit threads. All messages and posts about my surveys were clear that this is open to everyone for participation. (Evidence 8)

I tried to communicate with experts in gamer user profiling and all the relevant areas of interest. They had not responded to inquiries or any channels of communication, it could be a lack of communication or cultural sensitivity from my part. (Evidence 37)

One intercultural set of exchanges also took place in interviews. All of the participants were from different cultures: American, Dutch, Romanian, Bulgarian etc. One thing to notice when gauging the words that was used to make the superset repertory grid is that the English-native speakers tended to have more variety in words to connotations. But for the most part, they were less direct in describing

differences and what they like in avatars. Non-native English speakers who were not fluent tend to ramble to better voice what they were trying to mean when asked to differentiate between avatars. The solution for the uncomfortable ones or ones that were having difficulty in describing what they feel was to listen and voice out suggestions. Participants would either confirm or use these suggestions to better describe they perceive avatars as. Another aspect to work effectively in these interviews was to get these participants in a comfortable position to voice their opinions. Several non-native English speakers expressed that they were unsure about their answers in the interviews which was always reassured in the interview. Participants were never pushed or forced to say anything that they didn't feel. (Evidence 31)